GUIDANCE NOTE 11

Stormwater & soak wells

Every new roof sheds water somewhere. The plan has to show where — and it can't be next door.

THE RULE, IN ONE LINE

Perth councils expect stormwater to be **contained on your own lot**. On the sandy soils of the coastal plain that almost always means **soak wells**; on clay soils in the hills it takes designed storage or a lawful connection instead — soak wells barely work in clay. Roof water discharging over a boundary is both a neighbour dispute and a non-compliance, and it's the first thing checked when a new roof area is added.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

- ✓ **Soak well locations** marked on the site plan, with sizes (diameter × depth, or litres) for the new roof area.
- ✓ **Downpipe positions** and which soak well each connects to.
- ✓ **Clearance** from buildings, footings and boundaries — as a rule of thumb about 1.8 m unless the design says otherwise. A soak well hard against a footing undermines it; hard against a boundary, it drains the neighbour's ground too.
- ✓ **Overflow path** — where water goes in the storm the wells can't hold, falling away from buildings and not over the boundary.
- ✓ On clay or filled ground: the **designed alternative** — storage, connection to a council system where permitted, or an engineer's drainage detail.

COMMON REASONS WE COME BACK

- No stormwater shown at all — the single most common gap on Class 10 site plans.
- A soak well drawn under the new shed or its footings, with no design for it.
- Downpipes on the plan that don't connect to anything.
- New paving or patio area draining to the street or the neighbour.
- Soak wells on a hills block with reactive clay — where they won't actually soak.

> **Sizing:** councils vary on the design storm they require, and some publish their own soak-well sizing tables — check your council's page (linked under *Resources → Your local government*) or ask us and we'll tell you what your council expects.

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